HACK876

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Our ref: H876/PRN/ARD/2026-01

16 October 2026

BY HAND

Dr. Jacqueline Pinto
Acting Principal
Ardenne High School
10 Ardenne Road
Kingston 10

Dear Dr. Pinto,

Re: Invitation for Ardenne High School to take part in Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)

We write to invite students of Ardenne High School to take part in Hack 876, a free, one-day hackathon on Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative) at the Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica. Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form from schools across Kingston will work in teams of 3 to 4 to build a working prototype of an idea, then present it to judges from industry.

In March 2026 Ardenne became the pilot site for the UTech and Kiwanis STEM Education Project, and its Robotics Club is already building and demonstrating its work. Diandra McPherson, an Ardenne past student who works at Earle & Wilson, is helping Hack 876 as a community partner.

Taking part asks very little of Ardenne. There is no cost to the school or to students, nothing for the school to host, organize or transport, and no class time, because the event is on a Saturday. We ask only for a member of staff to act as our contact, and for teachers to share the opportunity with eligible students and recommend those who would enjoy it. The organizers handle consent forms and the event itself, and families receive safety details before the day. Whether students take part remains a decision for the school and for families.

We wrote to the school by email on 16 October 2026. In case that message did not reach your desk, we wanted you to have this in hand. To confirm Ardenne's participation, please email info@hack876.com, or ask a member of staff to do so. Campion College and Hillel Academy have confirmed their participation, and we would be honoured to welcome Ardenne students alongside them.

Yours sincerely,

Stefen Ewers
Co-organizer, Hack 876

Nadani Dixon
Co-organizer, Hack 876

Enc.: Hack 876 information booklet for Ardenne High School

HACK876 × DEO DUCE QUAERE OPTIMA · SIGILLUM SCHOLAE ARDENNIENSIS

INFORMATION BOOKLET FOR THE PRINCIPAL

An invitation for Ardenne High School

Build something that should exist.

Date	Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)
Hours	8:00 AM to 7:30 PM
Venue	Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica
Cost	Free for schools and students

Hack 876 is a one-day build competition for Jamaican secondary-school students. In teams of 3 to 4, students choose a real problem, build a prototype that addresses it, and present it to a panel of judges.

The Ardenne page

www.hack876.com/schools/ardenne

Prepared for Dr. Jacqueline Pinto, Acting Principal

Hack 876 is organized independently of Ardenne High School. This booklet sets out what the day involves and what we would ask of the school.

WHY ARDENNE

This already looks like Ardenne.

In March 2026, Ardenne became the pilot site for the UTech and Kiwanis STEM Education Project: hands-on robotics, coding and engineering.

STEAM
A school philosophy that pairs science and technology with the arts.

Robotics
An active Robotics Club already building and demonstrating.

STEM pilot
Launch site for the UTech and Kiwanis STEM Education Project, March 2026.

IT core
Every student entering grade 10 carries an IT-based core subject.

> **"We strongly believe that they're the future and they're the ones who will impact us and make changes that are necessary."**
>
> Dr. Jacqueline Pinto, Acting Principal, Ardenne High School · UTech Jamaica, March 2026

Hack 876 offers those same students another arena: one day, one team, one idea, build something real. It doesn't replace anything Ardenne is doing. It adds a deadline, outside judges, and students from other schools.

What students practise

- Defining a real problem
- Designing, building and testing a solution
- Teamwork with students from other schools
- Explaining their work to judges

These are among the skills assessed in CSEC Information Technology and in CAPE Computer Science and Digital Media. Hack 876 is independent of CXC and the Ministry, and taking part does not count toward any SBA.

THE DAY

One day, from first idea to working demo.

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a short, fixed time, then show it to judges. The word comes from "hack" in the sense of putting something together quickly. It has nothing to do with breaking into computers.

Many students will be at their first hackathon, and no coding experience is needed.

DATE TENTATIVE
Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)

VENUE CONFIRMED
Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston

HOURS
8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. One day, not overnight.

WHO
Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form

SIZE
About 80 students from several schools

TEAMS
3 to 4 students per team

The full schedule

One day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. Not overnight.

ARRIVE

8:00 AM	Doors open
9:00 AM	Opening
9:20 AM	Keynote
9:35 AM	Challenge reveal

BUILD

9:45 AM	Hacking begins
12:00 PM	Lunch
3:00 PM	Submissions open
4:00 PM	Hacking ends

SHOW

4:15 PM	Judging
5:30 PM	Finalists announced
5:45 PM	Finals

CELEBRATE

6:45 PM	Awards
7:00 PM	Photos + hangout
7:30 PM	That's a wrap

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

Real problems, working prototypes.

Each team picks a track for inspiration, chooses a real problem within it, and builds a working prototype. The tracks guide ideas. They do not limit them.

Life
Make everyday life better.

Learn
Rethink how people learn.

Culture
Build around Jamaican stories, creativity, language, or culture.

Business
Build for entrepreneurs and small businesses.

Move
Rethink transportation, mobility, and getting around.

Wellbeing
Create something that supports healthier lives.

Resilience
Think climate, infrastructure, emergencies, or community resilience.

Wildcard
Build something nobody asked for.

What teams can make
Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

What we ask every team to do

01
Solve something real.
Start with a problem or moment you actually understand.

02
Make something that works.
A rough demo that runs beats a perfect slide deck.

03
Try something bold.
Take a swing. Judges notice ambition.

04
Know what you built.
Explain how it works, why it matters, and what's next.

WHO WILL BE IN THE ROOM

Judges and organizers.



Dominic Saunders
Judge · Tesla
Campion College · Princeton



Jordan Howell
Judge · Microsoft
Campion College · Kettering



Joshua Ardito
Judge · Meta
Campion College · Carnegie Mellon



Tahj Atkinson
Judge · Google
Campion College · Illinois Tech



Kendall Todd
Judge · Accenture
Hillel Academy · UF



Netania Mundell
Judge · Diageo
St. Andrew High School for Girls · UWI · NYU



Sheneska Williams
Judge · HashiCorp (Terraform)
Immaculate Conception High School · USF

ORGANIZERS



Nadani Dixon
Organizer · Redfin
Campion College · Middlebury · Georgia Tech



Stefen Ewers
Organizer · Georgia Tech
Campion College · Hillel Academy · Georgia Tech

Organisations are each person's employer, listed for context. They are not event sponsors unless stated.

Confirmed schools: Campion College, Hillel Academy

CONFIRMED SPONSORS

P237 Labs · organizing partner

Lev Beauty

Vault Motors

Norus Technologies

Frankies

HOW WORK IS JUDGED

How the judges decide.

Each team demonstrates its project to the judges. These are the lenses they use, in plain language. There are no point values.

Problem & Insight
Did you find something worth fixing, and do you get why it matters?

Product & Solution
Does your idea actually answer the problem?

Execution
Does it work? How much did you really build today?

Originality
Is it fresh, or a new take on something familiar?

Impact
Who would this help, and how much?

Pitch & Demo
Can you show it and explain it clearly?

Complexity alone does not win Hack 876.

Prizes

Hack 876 Winner	iPad per student (up to 4)
Second Place	AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)
Third Place	US$150 gift card per student (up to 4)
Best Design	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)
Boldest Idea	US$200 team project grant
People's Choice	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Prizes are tentative and subject to change.

Prizes are a bonus; the experience of building is the point.

No. Hack 876 does not offer or promise internships, jobs, scholarships, interviews or placements.

SAFETY, SUPERVISION AND COST

What families and the school can rely on.

Supervision
Students are supervised by Hack 876 staff and volunteers for the whole day, at the Spanish Court Hotel.

One day
It is not overnight. Hack 876 runs for a single day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM, and every student goes home that evening.

Access and medical needs
Tell the organizers as early as possible, at info@hack876.com, so arrangements can be made with the venue.

AI tools
Students use only organizer-approved, age-appropriate tools. Students under 18 will not use adults-only tools at Hack 876, with or without permission.

Consent
Every participant needs a consent form signed by a parent or guardian. This applies whatever the student's age.

Food
Food is provided on the day, and the schedule includes a lunch break. Accepted students will be asked about allergies and dietary needs in advance.

Emergencies
Every family will be given an on-site contact and the emergency procedure before the event.

Conduct
The Code of Conduct and Event Rules are at www.hack876.com/code-of-conduct and www.hack876.com/rules.

Not provided

Transport: No transport has been arranged, so families should plan to bring students to the Spanish Court Hotel for 8:00 AM and collect them at 7:30 PM.

Devices: Every student needs to bring their own laptop or other device to build on, plus a charger. Hack 876 is not providing laptops or other hardware.

Cost

Hack 876 is free. There is no fee for the school or for students.

Being finalised, shared with families before the event

- **Supervision:** The number of supervising adults and the written safeguarding procedures.
- **On-site contact:** The on-site contact details.
- **AI tools:** Which tools are approved, and the age limit for each.
- **Consent form:** The exact wording of the form and how it is returned.
- **Arrival and collection:** Drop-off and pick-up procedures, and whether any transport will be arranged.
- **Food:** The menu.

NEXT STEPS

What we ask of Ardenne.

- Confirm Ardenne's participation by email to info@hack876.com.
- Name a member of staff as our contact.
- Share the opportunity with eligible students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, and recommend those who would enjoy it.
- Advise us on school permissions and on communication with parents.

Ardenne is not asked to pay, host, organize, transport or supervise anything.

For planning, we have roughly 8 to 12 Ardenne students in mind: an estimate, not a quota or a promise.

First	An email to info@hack876.com confirming Ardenne's participation and naming a staff contact.
Then	Teachers share the opportunity, and students apply.
Before the event	Accepted students and their families receive consent forms.
Event day	Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative).

Email info@hack876.com to confirm Ardenne's participation

We wrote to the school by email on 16 October 2026. In case that message did not reach your desk, we wanted you to have this in hand.

Stefen Ewers and Nadani Dixon, co-organizers · info@hack876.com

Prefer to talk first? Book 15 minutes: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

Hack 876

www.hack876.com

The Ardenne page

www.hack876.com /schools/ardenne

Ardenne has always asked its students to seek the best.

Let's give a few Ardennites one day to build it.